Knowledge Base Entry — Early Leadership, Trust & Operational Responsibility

Logistics Assistant (Substitute, Full-Time in Practice) — Back Up Vikar A/S

Role Overview

Early-career role within a large logistics center, initially as a substitute worker but quickly evolving into a **de facto full-time position with extended responsibility**. Although formally employed as a substitute, I was consistently requested by specific departments and entrusted with responsibilities typically reserved for permanent staff, based on reliability, judgment, and initiative.

Scope & Responsibilities

- Worked across multiple departments within the logistics center, with primary placement in the **Value Added Services (VAS)** department.
- Prepared and managed goods for shipment with **customer-specific requirements**, ensuring correctness, traceability, and quality.
- Trained new substitute workers and supported onboarding in departmental workflows.
- Periodically entrusted with **coordination and oversight of minor departments**, including:
    - Delegating daily tasks
    - Monitoring progress and quality
    - Ensuring correct data registration and documentation
- Frequently asked to step in where operational gaps arose, even outside formal responsibility.

Informal Leadership & Trust

- Became one of a small number of **preferred substitutes** requested directly by departments, resulting in near-continuous work and operational continuity.
- Entrusted by management with **responsibilities beyond formal authority**, with implicit approval from colleagues and supervisors despite contractual limitations.
- Asked by a manager to temporarily take over responsibilities during a colleague's stress-related sick leave—despite the presence of more senior, permanent employees—based on:
    - Proven reliability
    - Proactivity
    - Calm handling of responsibility
- Successfully managed the role for approximately one month, ensuring stability and continuity during a sensitive period.

Professional Attributes Demonstrated

- Early demonstration of **accountability without mandate**: taking responsibility where needed, even when not formally required or recognized.

- Strong situational awareness and ability to **coordinate people and tasks under operational pressure**.
- Earned trust through consistent delivery, discretion, and respect for both people and process.
- Comfortable stepping into leadership roles **when needed**, without seeking status or formal recognition.

Reusable Professional Insight

- “I learned early in my career that trust is built by showing up consistently, taking responsibility when it is needed, and prioritizing the stability of the team over formal titles.”

Core Keyword Cluster

Operational Responsibility · Informal Leadership · Team Coordination · Trust & Reliability · Quality Control · Training & Onboarding · Systems Awareness